FREE SAMPLE · October 22, 2026

Physics PhD Atlas 2027

10 of 104 programs from the full Atlas for international physics applicants (US, UK, Europe, Australia and Canada), with every value copied from the program's own official page.

Six things international physics applicants miss this cycle

1. **The Physics GRE is back at some top programs.** In the full Atlas, it's required this cycle at Brown (Physics track), Caltech, Cornell (theory applicants), Harvard, Stanford, Calgary (international applicants), Berkeley, UChicago, Guelph (applicants with non-Canadian degrees), Virginia (UVA).
2. **Some fees are free right now.** Penn State waives its fee for everyone with code PHYS2027. Rice runs a worldwide fee-waiver window until Nov 1, 2026.
3. **"My degree was in English" isn't always enough.** Most UK universities don't exempt Indian degrees, but QMUL accepts 70% in CBSE/ISC Class XII English and Royal Holloway 80% in Class 12 English. In Sweden, KTH and Chalmers accept CBSE/CISCE Class XII English grades. In North America, UT Austin exempts applicants from India outright, while Alberta's list includes the IITs and IISc but not the IISERs.
4. **TOEFL changed scales on Jan 21, 2026.** Programs now list two minimums (e.g., UBC: 90 old scale / 4.5 new scale).
5. **In Australia (and much of Canada), the supervisor comes first.** ANU requires a supervisor's written approval before admission and Melbourne a supervisor's written support before you apply. Waterloo requires a supervisor match.
6. **The UK and Europe run on funding deadlines and positions.** UK funding deadlines come first (Imperial's first scholarship round closes Nov 2, Warwick's Dec 7, Cambridge's Dec 8). Many UK, European and Australian programs charge no application fee (Imperial, Glasgow, EPFL, ANU among them). In Sweden, the Netherlands and Switzerland you usually apply for an advertised paid position.

Sample: 10 programs

Program	Deadline	Fee	Fee waiver (internationals)	Physics GRE	English-test waiver	Supervisor first?

ANU Australia	Apr 15, 2027	0 (no fee)	No application fee for research degrees, so no waiver needed	Not stated	For research degrees, completing a bachelor's of at least 3 years (or a master's of at least 2 years) taught and assessed entirely in English meets the requirement. Indian Class XII (CBSE/ISC) results are not accepted for research degrees, because the senior-secondary route does not apply to HDR. ANU says it grants no waivers beyond these routes.	Required
EPFL Switzerland	Apr 30, 2027	0 (no fee)	Not needed: no application fee	Not stated	No English test is strictly required; proficiency in English is required and TOEFL is strongly recommended	Required
Imperial College London United Kingdom	Nov 2, 2026	0 (no fee)	PhD applications carry no application fee, so no waiver is needed	Not stated	Exempt only with a UK-degree-equivalent qualification from a listed country (Australia, Canada, Guyana, Ireland, Malta, New Zealand, South Africa, UK, USA, West Indies); India is not listed	Not required
KTH Stockholm Sweden	Per position	Not stated	Not stated on the page checked	Not stated	Indian upper-secondary English can meet the requirement: CBSE (2008 onwards) or CISCE Class XII English grades, or an English-medium upper secondary certificate. The India page offers no degree-based route, so otherwise take a test	Required
Penn State USA	Jan 15, 2027	0 (waived)	Automatic for everyone this cycle via code PHYS2027 (international included)	Not stated	Rule is country-based ('non-English speaking countries'); exemption list not shown on the page checked	Not stated

Queen Mary (QMUL) United Kingdom	Jan 28, 2027	0 (no fee)	No application fee is charged, so no waiver is needed	Not stated	Indian Class XII English counts for Band 4: at least 70% in the English component of CBSE or ISC Standard XII, or at least 75% from selected state boards (Andhra Pradesh, Assam, Delhi, Goa, Karnataka, Kerala, Maharashtra, Manipur, Tamil Nadu, Tripura, West Bengal) if Queen Mary can verify the scores with the board. The result must be no more than 7 years before the course start. A degree waives the test only if it was delivered in a majority English-speaking country, so an Indian degree does not.	Required
Rice USA	Dec 15, 2026	85 USD	Doctoral Fee Waiver Weeks open to students worldwide Oct 14-Nov 1, 2026 (or until waivers run out); completed application due Nov 27. Also waived for Texas/neighbouring-state students, GCURS speakers, Fulbright Scholars.	Not considered	Exemption rules not shown on the department page checked	Not stated
Stanford USA	Dec 14, 2026	Not stated	Some applicants may qualify; see Stanford Graduate Admissions fee-waiver page for eligibility	Required	Not required if your degree (or international equivalent) is from a university where ALL instruction was in English; no documents needed at application	Not stated
UBC Canada	Dec 1, 2026	168.25 CAD	Automatic waiver only for citizens AND residents of the UN's 50 least developed countries (India is not on that list)	Not required	Test required only if your university's primary language of instruction is not English (confirm with the program for your institution)	Not required

UT Austin USA	Dec 1, 2026	90 USD	Graduate School waivers for applicants meeting certain criteria; department not involved. Check criteria for international eligibility.	Optional	India is on UT's list of qualifying countries exempt from TOEFL/IELTS (also exempt with a bachelor's from a U.S./qualifying-country institution)	Not stated

Deadline years are inferred where a page gives only a day and month. Confirm every value on the official page before paying or submitting.

The full kit

- **Offline explorer** for all 104 programs: filter by Physics GRE, English waiver, fee waivers and supervisor rules, and tap any value to see the official quote.
- **Planner workbook**: auto-filling shortlist, deadline countdown, fee budget, recommender and supervisor-outreach trackers.
- **Playbook**: timeline, rupee budget, English-test rules for Indian degrees, GRE decisions, how the UK, Europe, Australia and Canada differ, supervisor emails, physics SOP framework, letter kit, ethical fee-waiver requests.
- Free updates for the Fall 2027 cycle. 14-day refund.

Priced for students: about ₹190 in India (Gumroad shows rupees and accepts UPI), $5 elsewhere. A batch licence covers up to 30 students for about ₹750. Can't afford it? Reply to your receipt for a free copy.

Not affiliated with any university. Not immigration, visa or legal advice.